Document 15: Tuition Fee Structure & Refund Policy

Institution: Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT)

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1. Standard Annual Tuition and Consolidated Fee Components

The financial architecture of the Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT) is designed to be fully transparent, with all annual costs strictly defined at the commencement of the academic year. The university does not charge arbitrary "donation" fees or hidden monthly levies. The total financial obligation for a standard undergraduate student is consolidated into a single Annual Institutional Fee, which must be cleared prior to the commencement of the odd semester (typically in August).

The Annual Institutional Fee is bifurcated into three distinct sub-components: First, the Core Academic Tuition Fee. For students admitted under the Category-A (Convener Quota), the core tuition is fixed by the State Fee Regulatory Committee at ₹1,45,000 per academic year. For students admitted under the Category-B (Management/NRI Quota), the core tuition is strictly fixed at ₹3,20,000 per academic year. This core tuition covers all classroom instruction, standard laboratory access, and internal examination evaluations.

Second, the Mandatory Infrastructure and Development Fee. Every student, regardless of their admission category or scholarship status, must pay a flat development fee of ₹15,000 per year. This fund is exclusively ring-fenced for upgrading the high-speed campus Wi-Fi grid, purchasing licensed enterprise software (such as MATLAB, AutoCAD, and IBM SPSS), and modernizing the biometric security framework.

Third, the Comprehensive Student Services Levy. This is a non-negotiable annual charge of ₹8,500. It covers the mandatory student health insurance premium, access to the primary campus medical clinic, membership to the Student Activities Council (SAC), and the annual subscription to the digital library databases.

2. Payment Timelines and Escalating Late Fee Protocols

The university accounts department strictly enforces payment deadlines to maintain the institution's operational cash flow. The official deadline for clearing the Annual Institutional Fee is July 25th of every academic year, precisely two weeks before the commencement of odd semester classes.

HIT does not offer EMI (Equated Monthly Installment) schemes, nor does it allow students to split the annual fee into semester-wise payments. The entire consolidated amount must be paid in a single transaction. Failure to meet the July 25th deadline triggers an automated, escalating penalty system embedded within the financial portal.

- **Tier 1 Penalty (Days 1 to 5):** If the payment is processed between July 26th and July 30th, the portal automatically adds a late fine of ₹500 for every single day the payment is delayed.
- **Tier 2 Penalty (Days 6 to 15):** If the delay extends beyond July 30th, the penalty structure becomes punitive. From July 31st to August 9th, the daily fine increases to ₹1,000 per day.
- **Tier 3 Portal Lockout (Day 16 onwards):** If a student fails to clear the total fee and the accumulated late fines by August 10th, their financial portal is entirely frozen. Their biometric campus access is instantly revoked, rendering them unable to enter the campus, attend classes, or access the hostel mess. To reinstate their active student status, the student must pay a massive fixed "Unfreezing Penalty" of ₹15,000 in addition to their core tuition fee and previously accumulated daily fines.

3. State Fee Reimbursement and Scholarship Adjustments

A significant portion of students admitted under the Category-A Convener Quota rely on the State Government's Fee Reimbursement Scheme (E-Pass). The university strictly regulates how these external government funds interact with the institutional billing cycles.

Students eligible for full state fee reimbursement (e.g., SC/ST candidates or those with a verified parental income below ₹2,00,000) are temporarily exempted from paying the Core Academic Tuition Fee of ₹1,45,000 during the July payment window. However, they are still legally obligated to pay the ₹15,000 Development Fee and the ₹8,500 Student Services Levy out of pocket before the July 25th deadline.

Crucially, the university holds the student ultimately liable for the tuition fee, not the government. If the State Government rejects a student's E-Pass application due to faulty income certificates, or if the government delays the disbursement of the reimbursement funds beyond March 31st of that academic year, the temporary exemption is revoked. The university will immediately issue a demand notice directly to the student. The student must pay the entire ₹1,45,000 out of their own personal funds within fourteen days of receiving the notice to receive their final examination Hall Ticket.

4. Digital Payment Gateways and Dishonored Transactions

To eliminate the risk of theft and ensure instantaneous ledger reconciliation, the HIT accounts department operates entirely on a cashless basis. Cash payments, regardless of the amount, are strictly prohibited and will be rejected by the teller windows.

All institutional fees, including tuition, hostel rent, and library fines, must be processed through the unified HIT Student Financial Portal. The portal exclusively accepts payments via National Electronic Funds Transfer (NEFT), Real-Time Gross Settlement (RTGS), verified Unified Payments Interface (UPI) handles, and major domestic Credit/Debit cards.

The university imposes severe penalties for failed or dishonored financial transactions. If a student attempts to pay via a bank transfer that bounces due to insufficient funds, or if a credit card transaction is retroactively subjected to a fraudulent chargeback claim by the student's parent, it is classified as a Tier-2 Disciplinary Financial Violation. The student's portal will be locked, a dishonored transaction fine of ₹5,000 will be instantly levied, and the university reserves the right to withhold all academic transcripts until the dispute is resolved and the principal amount is credited to the university's corporate account.

5. Strict Refund Slabs for First-Year Admission Cancellation

The university recognizes that newly admitted first-year students may wish to cancel their admission if they secure a seat in an NIT, IIT, or a preferred medical college during later phases of state or national counseling. To govern this, HIT enforces a strict, time-sensitive refund matrix.

The refund slabs are calculated based on the official notification dates of the State EAMCET Counseling phases:

1. **Cancellation Before Phase 2 of State Counseling:** If a student formally submits an admission withdrawal request before the commencement of the second phase of state counseling, they are entitled to a 100% refund of their paid tuition fee. However, the university will deduct a non-refundable administrative processing charge of ₹5,000. All original certificates (10th, 12th, TC) will be returned within 48 hours.
2. **Cancellation After Phase 2 but Before Final Phase:** If the withdrawal request is submitted after Phase 2 begins but before the Final Spot-Counseling round concludes, the university will refund exactly 50% of the paid tuition fee. The ₹15,000 Development Fee and ₹8,500 Student Services Levy are entirely non-refundable in this slab.
3. **Cancellation After Final Spot-Counseling Phase:** Once the final phase of state counseling is officially concluded, the university admissions register is permanently locked. If a student requests to cancel their admission after this date, the refund percentage drops to absolute zero. Because the university cannot legally fill that vacated seat with another student for the remaining four years, the entire first-year fee is forfeited to the institution.

6. Mid-Degree Dropout Liability and the "Remainder Course Fee" Rule

The financial penalties for dropping out of the B.Tech program become exponentially more severe after the first year concludes. The university strictly enforces the "Remainder Course Fee" liability doctrine to protect institutional revenue against mid-degree student attrition.

If a student decides to permanently withdraw from the university during their second, third, or fourth year of study—whether due to securing an opportunity to study abroad, launching a startup, or citing personal lack of interest in engineering—they cannot simply stop attending classes and request their original high school certificates back.

Because the student occupied a seat that could have been allocated to a paying candidate during the initial admission phase, they are legally liable for the financial loss caused to the university. To obtain their original Transfer Certificate (TC), 10th Standard Marks Memo, and 12th Standard Pass Certificate from the university vaults, the dropping-out student must pay the full Core Academic Tuition Fee for the remaining, unstudied years of the degree. For example, if a Category-A student drops out at the end of their second year, they must pay ₹2,90,000 (covering the third and fourth years) in a single lump sum before the university administration will release their original educational documents.

7. Examination, Supplementary, and Challenge Valuation Fees

The core tuition fee only covers the student's first attempt at standard internal and external examinations. Any deviation from the standard academic progression incurs independent administrative fees, which must be cleared before the Hall Tickets are generated.

- **Standard Semester Exam Fee:** A nominal processing fee of ₹1,500 is charged at the end of every semester to cover the logistical costs of printing customized barcode answer booklets and digital evaluation hosting.
- **Supplementary (Backlog) Examination Fee:** If a student fails a subject and must re-appear for a supplementary examination, they are charged a flat rate of ₹1,000 per theory subject and ₹1,500 per practical laboratory subject. There is no cap on this fee; if a student has five backlogs, they must pay ₹5,000.
- **Re-Evaluation and Challenge Valuation:** As detailed in the Examination Manual, requesting a digital photocopy of a graded answer script costs a non-refundable ₹500. If the student proceeds to officially challenge the valuation, they must deposit ₹3,000 per script. This ₹3,000 is fully refunded if the student's grade increases by more than 15%; otherwise, the entire deposit is forfeited to the examination branch.